RESOLUTION No. 7185

Resolution Proclaiming the Celebration of National Hispanic Heritage Month in Portland Public Schools

RECITALS

A. Hispanic Heritage Month was started as a heritage week in 1968 and begins on September 15, which is the anniversary of the independence of five Latin American countries: Costa Rica, El Salvador, Guatemala, Honduras, and Nicaragua.

B. Hispanics and Latinos have enriched and positively shaped our community. From those whose roots trace back generations to those who have recently arrived to pursue the promise of the United States, they represent the spirit of our American Dream: with hard work and an education, you can build a better life for yourself and a better future for your children and make profound contribution in education, medicine, art, culture, and public service and have been a consistent and vital influence in our community's growth and prosperity.

C. Our schools honor and preserve the linguistic and cultural assets of students through student clubs like MECHA and enrichment programs such as our Dual Language Immersion, Ethnic Studies, Critical Race Theory courses, and the option to obtain a seal of Biliteracy upon graduation that honor and enrich the diverse backgrounds of our heritage Spanish-speakers, while exposing non-Spanish speakers to diverse multilingual and multicultural perspectives;

D. We recognize that when we lift up Hispanic/Latino students, staff, families, and community members, we strengthen our entire district; when we create more pathways to educational opportunity, we provide the chance for all students to reach their greatest potential;

E. Understanding, recognizing, and promoting the assets of our Hispanic and Latino students, staff, families and community is an important part of celebrating Hispanic Heritage Month;

F. Portland Public Schools has a Racial Education Equity Policy that is aligned to our District's vision of the Graduate Portrait and states our commitment to affirmatively overcome the educational barriers that have resulted in a persistent, unacceptable gap for students of color and to give each student the opportunity and support to meet his or her highest potential;

G. Closing opportunity gaps while raising achievement for all students is the top priority of the Board of Education, the Superintendent, and all district staff; and

H. The Portland Public Schools Board of Education believes each and every student is to be celebrated and appreciated for the distinct and vibrant contributions made by sharing cultures, language, ideas, beliefs and values within a school community.

RESOLVED

The Portland Public Schools Board of Education hereby promotes September 15th through October 15th as Hispanic Heritage Month and encourages staff, students, and community to observe, recognize, and celebrate the culture, heritage, and economic contributions of Hispanics andLatinos to Portland, Oregon, and the United States through culturally relevant activity, and to learn from the past and understand the experiences that have shaped the United States.